



A good crowd from Almonte and elsewhere turned out to compete in the Legion Horsehoe Tournament held in Gemmill Park Sunday. Here Jack Horton of Almonte concentrates on the pitch.

Getting alfalfa ready for winter

by R.C. Bradford, P. Ag.,
agricultural representative

Winterizing the alfalfa crop

Good crop management dictates that August is the month to start getting the alfalfa crop ready for winter. Just as the automobile needs antifreeze in the radiator, so the alfalfa crop requires its antifreeze — potash — fertilizer.

A low potassium (K) level in the soil is one of the major factors leading to loss of alfalfa from a stand. This is particularly true on loam and sandy, loam soils, which usually need added K.

Unless these soils have been built up through fertilizer or manure use, K levels, and the potential to release potassium on such soil is naturally low, compared to clay and clay loam soils. Many clay soils in Ontario require very little or no potassium for alfalfa production.

Alfalfa plants require potassium (K) stored in the tap root for satisfactory survival over winter. Low potassium interferes with the storage of sufficient carbohydrates in the root, thereby reducing the resistance of the alfalfa roots and growth buds to low freezing temperatures.

The potash fertilizer treatment should be applied during the last half of August for greatest benefit. Unfortunately the fertilizer is too frequently spread later in the fall when it has little effect for winter survival of the alfalfa crop.

All of our forage plants (alfalfa, other legumes and grasses) remove much larger amounts of K from the soil than do crops such as grain corn or the cereals.

Analyses on forages conducted by the Ontario Feed Analysis Laboratory show that each tonne of forage harvested removes about 25 kg of potassium per acre. In the life of a forage stand under good management and high yields, a large amount of K can be removed by the crop.

The problem of low K levels in alfalfa grasses, mixtures is even greater, as these grasses are much more efficient in absorbing this nutrient from the soil than is alfalfa. If there isn't enough to adequately go around, the grasses get their potassium requirement while the alfalfa is starved.

Forage stands should be soil sampled regularly and the recommended fertilizer applied each year just before the September rest period to prevent losses due to a lack of potassium.

Each year more alfalfa growers are applying generous amounts of potash. Alfalfa is a heavy feeder of potash. Of course, a large amount of the total need will be obtained by natural soil release. Even so, there is still a need to apply potash.

If no other information is available, such as the results of a soil analysis to indicate the potash fertilizer application rate, an application of 0.10 to 0.30 kg (100 to 300 lbs. per acre) could be appropriate.

Coming events

4-H Agricultural Judging Competition, August 13, 1980 - 9 a.m., Perth Fair Grounds, Perth, Ontario

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SATURDAY, AUGUST 9th
at 10:00 a.m. for MR. and MRS. GEORGE MELROSE at their home just South of Highway 7 on the United Cemetery Sideload approx. 3 miles East of Carleton Place

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COLLECT

Wheat harvest halted

The Ontario winter wheat harvest came to an abrupt end July 28 after heavy rains and high humidity.

According to officials of the Ontario Wheat Producers' Marketing Board, the 1980 harvest had started over a wide area of Essex County July 25 and to a lesser extent in Kent and Lambton counties, with isolated starts in other eastern areas as well.

Board chairman Robert Butler, RR 2, Croton, echoed concern of other wheat producers who have wheat still to be harvested.

Butler said clearing dry weather is urgently needed to permit harvest operations to resume.

Excessive moisture during the critical harvest period can

result in the grain germinating or sprouting in the wheat heads. That condition results in grade discounts to the producer according to the percentage of damage. The maximum discount for Sample or Feed grade is \$20.20 per tonne.

The marketing board has about 400,000 tonnes of the estimated 750,000 tonnes 1980 crop committed in export and domestic sales to date.

At the time of the board's report released on July 29, it

was estimated approximately 75 per cent of the Essex County wheat crop was harvested, while Kent and Lambton were about 25 per cent complete.

The board also announced the price of wheat to processors for domestic human consumption for August and September has been set at \$209.95 per tonne f.o.b. country shipping point. The price for June and July has been \$175.12 per tonne.

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PAKENHAM UNION CEMETERY

The Annual
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will be held
Sunday, August 10, 1980
at 2:30 p.m.

COUNTY OF LANARK ROADS DEPARTMENT TENDERS

For Equipment Rental, Rock Excavation, Earth Fill and Granular Materials

SEALED TENDERS, clearly marked as to contents will be received by the undersigned until:

11:00 A.M. FRIDAY, AUGUST 15, 1980

For the above noted items on County Road 16, near Middleville.

Estimated quantities are as follows:

Earth Borrow — 900 Cubic Yards
Granular "C" — 2600 Cubic Yards
Granular "A" — 1350 Tons
Rock: Drilling & Blasting — 1550 Cubic Yards
101-135 H.P. Bulldozer — 80 Hours

Tenders must be submitted on forms supplied by the County, and which are available at the County Engineer's Office.

Lowest or any tender not necessarily accepted.

R. B. STRACHAN, P.Eng.
County Engineer
County of Lanark
43 Drummond Street East
Perth, Ontario K7H 1G1
267-2244

AUCTION SALE

of HOUSEHOLD EFFECTS and ANTIQUES from the home of MR. WALTER SCOTT corner of Renfrew and Victoria Street Pakenham Village (near Post Office)

SATURDAY, AUGUST 9th
Time — 10:00 a.m.

THIS SALE INCLUDES MANY ARTICLES MOSTLY ANTIQUES

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MONDAY, AUGUST 18th
10:00 a.m.

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ONTARIO GOVERNMENT NOTICE

Information Centre

The Ministry of Transportation and Communications will be presenting their proposal for the closing of the following roads in the Township of West Carleton, Geographic Townships of Huntley and Fitzroy, Regional Municipality of Ottawa-Carleton, where they intersect or run into the controlled-access known as Highway 17 (New) as follows:

GEOGRAPHIC TOWNSHIP OF HUNTLEY

Closing No. 1 and 2 — Part of the road allowance between Concessions 5 and 6 adjacent to Lot 17 (unopened on the south side)

Note: A service road connecting the northern portion of the road allowance with former Highway 17 will be constructed at the time of the four-lane freeway

Closing No. 3 and 4 — Part of the road allowance between Concessions 6 and 7 adjacent to lots 20 and 21

Note: Service roads will be constructed to connect this road allowance with the road allowance between lots 20 and 21, Concessions 6 and 7 at the time of the four-lane freeway

Closing No. 5 and 8 — Part of the road allowance between lots 20 and 21, Concessions 6 and 7

Note: A flyover will be constructed at the time of the four-lane freeway

Closing No. 7 and 8 — Part of the road allowance between Concessions 7 and 8, adjacent to Lots 24 and 25 (unopened)

Closing No. 9 and 10 — Part of the road allowance between Concessions 8 and 9 adjacent to lot 27 (unopened on the north side)

Note: A service road will be constructed to connect this road allowance with the road allowance between the Geographic Townships of Huntley and Fitzroy south of the highway and an interchange will be constructed at the time of the four-lane freeway

GEOGRAPHIC TOWNSHIP OF FITZROY

Closing No. 11 — Part of the road allowance between Concessions 3 and 4 adjacent to Lots 3 and 4

Note: A turning basin will be constructed on the southerly side of the highway at the time of the four-lane freeway

Closing No. 12 and 13 — Part of the road allowance between Lots 5 and 6, Concessions 3 and 4

Note: Turning basins will be constructed on both sides of the highway at the time of the four-lane freeway

This Information Centre will be held at the West Carleton Municipal Offices located on Regional Road 5, R.R. No. 3, Carp on Tuesday, August 26, from 2:00 p.m. to 4:00 p.m. and from 8:00 p.m. to 9:00 p.m. The public are encouraged to attend

For further information, please contact the Ministry of Transportation and Communications at

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